FORGE '26 · GEN AI BUILDATHON · CIVIC PULSE, DIGITAL GOVERNANCE & PUBLIC INFORMATION

FactVerify Civic Agent

Check it's real. Then apply safely.

An AI team that tells citizens, in their own language, whether a message about a government scheme is real or a scam, why, and what to do. If it is real, an AI agent fills the application, and it always asks the citizen before submitting.

Live demo factverify-civic-agent.onrender.com

Code github.com/Zero-hub101/Zero-fact-verify-civic-agent

Team Scene Boys: Kiruthik Pranav B K · Kavin Raj B · Karthikeyan S

Independent student project. Not affiliated with or endorsed by any government body.

THE PROBLEM

Fake scheme messages cost families money and trust

"Pay ₹499 registration fee to get ₹50,000 scholarship. Share the OTP on WhatsApp within 24 hours."

A typical forward, often in Hindi, Tamil or Hinglish, sometimes with an edited copy of a real notice.

- **Who is hurt:** students, farmers, senior citizens and their families, often reading in their own language.
- **Why it works:** real schemes and fake ones look alike; official portals are hard to use; people are rushed.
- **The cost:** lost money and personal data, and real benefits go unclaimed because people stop trusting genuine notices.
- **The need:** a simple, trustworthy check in their language before acting, then a safe route to apply.

THE SOLUTION

Paste it. Understand it. Apply safely.

1 · Paste

The message (any Indian language or Hinglish), a link, or a photo or video of the notice.

2 · Plain answer

"This looks like a scam" or "This looks genuine", **why** and **what to do**, in the citizen's language, with a spoken reply.

3 · Apply safely

If genuine, an AI agent fills the form step by step. The human solves the CAPTCHA and approves the final submit.

Scam example

"Do not pay any money or share an OTP. Apply only on scholarships.gov.in. If you already paid, call 1930 or report at cybercrime.gov.in."

Genuine example

Matched to the real Central Sector Scheme of Scholarship (₹12,000/year, income up to ₹4.5 lakh) and linked to the official website.

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KEY FEATURES

What makes it reliable

AI team, one job each

Gemini researches and reads images (and backs up every role), Sarvam translates and speaks Indian languages, OCR.space reads text in images, Sightengine checks for AI-made images, Groq gives an independent second opinion.

Catches disguised scams

Fee and OTP requests even when written "0TP" or "6 digit code", personal UPI IDs, WhatsApp-only applications, look-alike "gov-in" links, edited photos and videos (compression and frame forensics).

Real data, no mock datasets

Real central schemes (Central Sector Scholarship, PM-KISAN, Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY) with official sources, plus live AI research on every claim.

Safe by design

Agent runs only on approved sites, max 10 steps, with human gates. Data encrypted (AES-256) and deleted after 24 h. Every step is logged in a tamper-proof, hash-chained record with a downloadable report.

TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

How it is built

React client

Plain-language results, voice playback, fact-checker console, mobile layout.

FastAPI server

Input validation, rate limiting, audit trail, Markdown provenance reports.

Verification engine

Scheme matching, scam-pattern rules (multi-script, disguise-aware), JPEG-ghost, copy-move and video frame forensics.

AI router

Roles (research, translation, speech, voice, OCR, image AI, vision, review) with ordered fallbacks; Gemini as universal backup; every answer validated.

Browser agent

Playwright playbooks; pauses for CAPTCHA, approval, missing data and payment pages; captures receipt and PDF.

Data & security

SQLite with AES-256-GCM profiles, 24 h wipe, append-only hash-chained receipts.

Caching

Paid AI results remembered for 24 h: repeat checks are instant and cost nothing.

Deployment

Docker on Render (ffmpeg + Chromium), /health endpoint, keys kept in host settings, never in code.

Tested with 66 automated tests and 16,000+ stress-test inputs (broken links, corrupt files, junk AI answers, disguised scams).

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IMPACT & FUTURE SCOPE

Where it goes next

- **More schemes, automatically:** load official scheme data from open government datasets so every central and state scheme is covered.
- **Where people already are:** a WhatsApp / SMS helpline that answers forwards directly, by text and voice.
- **More languages and voices** for all 22 scheduled languages.
- **Real portals, with permission:** agent playbooks built together with the official portal owners.
- **Reporting:** send confirmed scams to fact-checkers and cyber crime reporting in one tap.

Honest limits today

Forensics give signals, not proof. Free AI keys mean live web search is limited, so unsourced research is weighted lower. The agent demo uses a clearly labelled practice copy of the scholarship form; it never submits to a real government site.

Try it: factverify-civic-agent.onrender.com